

He Asked for Water. The AI Took It First.

Posted by u/AlperOmerEsin • 0 points • 8 comments

Training large AI models consumes massive amounts of water. Data centers use water for cooling, and when models like GPT or image generators are trained, the servers run intensely for days or weeks. According to some estimates, training just one powerful model can consume as much water as 300 households in a month. While AI may seem like it's "in the cloud", it's deeply rooted in physical resources — and water is one of the most quietly drained.

Comments

u/MrDevGuyMcCoder • 1 points • 2025-04-11 01:24 UTC

Good ol monger of the fear and ignorance here, nothing to see, move on

u/Superseaslug • 5 points • 2025-04-11 01:20 UTC

So, a key point here, water is consumed through evaporative cooling, meaning the water goes into the atmosphere, where it then rains back down and returns to where we got it. It didn't have to be processed to be usable again, and you can just filter it out from a steam or something

u/AlperOmerEsin • -2 points • 2025-04-11 04:10 UTC

But there is a situation. Fresh water is used for these processes and there are limited potable water resources in the world. If you search the internet for "how many people still do not have access to drinking water in the world right now?" you can see that there are millions of people.

u/Superseaslug • 1 points • 2025-04-11 04:50 UTC

Ah yes, because the AI could instead ship the water to the desert.

This is the same logic as your parents telling you to finish your food because some kid in Africa is starving.

If you tap a river that isn't endangered, or drill wells where there is a healthy water table, all the water makes its way back to the source, uncontaminated. Furthermore, you don't need potable water. As long as it's relatively clean it should be fine. It's evaporative cooling, it doesn't have to be sterile, just filtered.

u/Yet_One_More_Idiot • 2 points • 2025-04-11 00:17 UTC

Genuine question: Can seawater be cycled through as coolant, or does it have to be pure desalinated drinkable water?

u/AlperOmerEsin • 1 points • 2025-04-11 00:44 UTC

AI's answer: Seawater can be used in AI cooling systems, but not directly. Seawater contains salt and other minerals, which can cause corrosion and blockages in cooling systems. Therefore, seawater must be purified and desalinated before use.

There are several methods for desalinating seawater. The most common of these are reverse osmosis and distillation. Reverse osmosis separates salt and other minerals from seawater by passing it through a semi-permeable membrane. Distillation separates salt and other minerals from seawater by evaporating it and then condensing the vapor.

Desalinated seawater can be safely used in AI cooling systems. However, desalination can be costly, and in some cases it may be more economical to use fresh water.

u/Yet_One_More_Idiot • 2 points • 2025-04-11 00:59 UTC

Sooo....seawater cannot be used, it DOES have to be desalinated. xD

Classic ChatGPT: The answer is yes, except no.

u/AutoModerator • 1 points • 2025-04-11 00:11 UTC

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